

1916-2004

Nobel Prize-winning British biophysicist Francis Crick is celebrated for his joint 1953 discovery of the structure of DNA, one of the most significant breakthroughs in scientific history.

Francis Crick studied physics at University College London, then began graduate work there on the viscosity of water. During World War II, he was recruited by the Royal Navy to help develop magnetic and acoustic mines, and afterward decided to retrain in biology. In 1949, he joined the Cavendish Laboratory in Cambridge and began a new PhD on the X-ray diffraction of proteins. It was here, in 1951, that Crick met James Watson, with whom he would unlock one of science's greatest mysteries. They had an immediate connection and collaborated in the race to discover the molecular structure of DNA. In 1954, Crick completed his PhD, and went on to make key contributions in the ongoing study of genetic code. He moved to California in 1976, where he studied developmental neurobiology and human consciousness.

MILESTONES

CAMBRIDGE WORK

Starts PhD at the Cavendish Laboratory in 1949; meets Watson in 1951, and starts investigating DNA.

DOUBLE HELIX

Co-publishes a landmark paper in *Nature* on April 25, 1953, revealing the structure of DNA.

PRESTIGIOUS HONORS

Receives awards, including the Nobel Prize in 1962, and medals from the Royal Society in 1972 and 1975.

GAINS PROFESSORSHIP

Becomes Distinguished Research Professor at Salk Institute for Biological Studies, California, in 1977.

“The **genetic code** is ... the **key** to molecular biology.”

Francis Crick, 1966

FRANCIS

CRICK

